GAPTHEMIND INTERACTIVE STORIES

THE SIXTH ASTRONAUT

AN INTERACTIVE
CHOOSE-YOUR-OWN-ADVENTURE MYSTERY

Someone has been cut
out of the photo.

B1-B2
ENGLISH LEARNERS

AGES
11-15

10 POSSIBLE ENDINGS

Start



HOW THIS STORY WORKS





01 **Read** each page. The small line at the top gives the day, the time and the place.

02 **Count** the days. Day 1 is the day you arrive. Day 0 is the day before, and Day -1 is the day before that. Logs use these numbers.

03 **Choose** one of the two buttons at the bottom of the page. Each choice takes you to a different part of the story.

04 **Notice** what you see and what people say. They are not always the same.

05 **Replay** to follow other people and find other clues. What you find changes what you can prove.

Back

Next

THE SIXTH ASTRONAUT

WHO IS ON THE STATION



YOU

The new crew member. You arrived today.



COMMANDER HANA LINDQVIST

In charge of the station. Calm and exact.



DEV RAO

Engineer for air, water and cooling. Nervous.



KENJI SATO

Flies the robot arm and does spacewalks. Talkative.



DR MARISOL QUINN

The crew doctor. Soft voice.



GROUND

Mission Control on Earth. A voice on the speaker.

Back

Begin

THE SIXTH ASTRONAUT

THE DOCKING HATCH

DAY 1 09:40 GMT



The hatch opens with a soft thump, and you float into the International Space Station. The air smells of metal, hot plastic and old tea. Commander Hana Lindqvist helps you through. She is tall and calm, and she smiles with her mouth only. 'Welcome aboard. You make five of us.'

Behind her, a crew photo is taped to the wall. Four people grin at the camera. Between Dev Rao and Kenji Sato there is a pale square, where a face has been cut out. Under it, a name label has been scratched off.

Rao sees you looking. He stops smiling. Sato starts talking about lunch, very loudly. Dr. Quinn studies her own fingernails.

Back

A Ask who is missing from the photo

B Say nothing and ask to see your sleeping pod

THE GALLEY

DAY 1 11:00 GMT

'Someone is missing,' you say. 'There is a gap in the crew photo, between Dev and Kenji.'

The galley goes silent. Lindqvist's smile does not move. 'Nobody. **There were always five of us, counting you.**'

A speaker on the wall crackles. A man's voice comes from Mission Control, polite and flat.

MISSION CONTROL

> Station, Ground. A reminder for our new arrival. There is no sixth crew member on this mission. There never was. If anyone says otherwise, tell us at once. Please confirm.

You never said the word 'sixth'. Someone on Earth did.

'Confirmed,' says the Commander. Her eyes ask you to say it too. Everyone is waiting.



Back

A Say 'Confirmed' and let it go

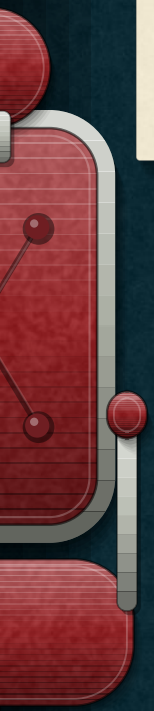
B Say 'I do not confirm it. Who was it?'

Start again

THE GALLEY

You give the confirmation. Eventually, the others return to their work.

You leave the galley and head for the Cupola. You need to see the station for yourself.



THE SLEEPING PODS

DAY 1 10:30 GMT



Six sleeping pods line the corridor, like narrow cupboards. Five have a name on the door. The sixth has a blank strip with sticky marks on it, where a name was peeled off.

You slide the door open. Inside there is a folded blanket, a hair clip with a small blue star, a faded mission badge from years ago, and a faint smell of lemon soap. Somebody lived here, and not long ago.

'That pod is storage.'

Dr. Marisol Quinn is behind you. She says it too fast, like a lesson learned by heart. Her hands are shaking. 'Please come away. You need to rest before your first night.'

Back

A Ask the Commander what is going on

B Close the door and wait until evening

Start again

THE GALLEY

DAY 1 11:00 GMT

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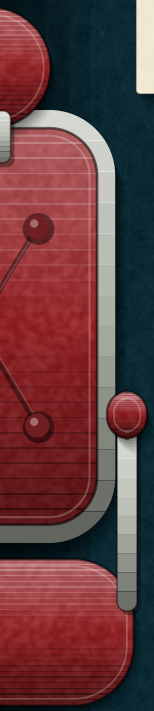
A Say 'Confirmed' and let it go

B Say 'I do not confirm it. Who was it?'

Start again

THE SLEEPING PODS

You close the door and keep what you saw to yourself. When evening comes, you head for the Cupola. You need to see the station for yourself.



THE SIXTH ASTRONAUT • FREE SAMPLE

YOUR INVESTIGATION ISN'T OVER

You've seen the first clues. You've made your first decisions. But the truth about the sixth astronaut is still waiting to be uncovered.

GET THE COMPLETE STORY TO:

- Continue making decisions.
- Follow the evidence.
- Discover the possible endings.

10 POSSIBLE ENDINGS



CONTINUE THE INVESTIGATION

Get the complete interactive PDF on Payhip.

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